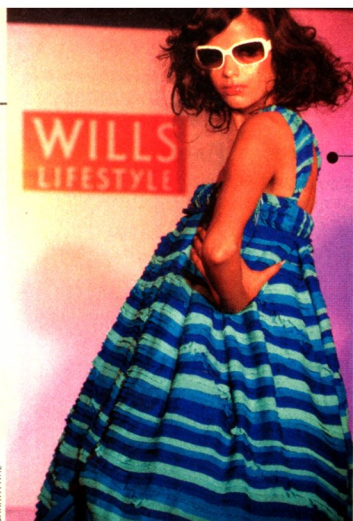




SHREYA PATIL

SLINKY STRIPES

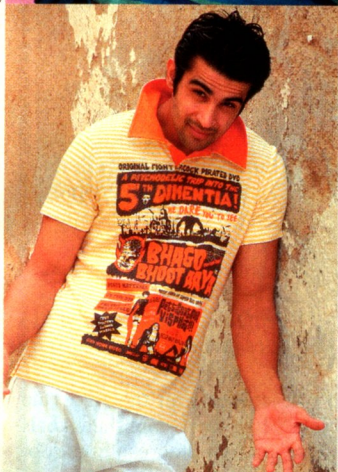
From sailor's stripes to Rohit Bal's indigo illusion, undulating stripes bring a twist to textile and fashion hits a horizontal bend.

SPORTY SPICE

Pockets and parkas bring a playful touch. Sporty graphics jazz up Abhishek Gupta and Nandita Basu's Cent Percent Indian.

MAXI-MUM COVER

Gauri & Nainika Karan present flowing styles that sweep the floor in airy colours.



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Puissegur". Her collection Happy Day is a "Cuban-flavoured travelogue with pleated skirts, off-shoulder dresses, wide-legged pants and sporty evening-wear, in bold, vibrant hues". Abhishek Gupta and Nandita Basu's Fightercock draws inspiration from psychedelic artists and transfers graphic prints on a "sexy, tongue-in-cheek" collection celebrating 60 years of Indian Independence, titled Cent Percent Indian. Taking off on a similar artistic tangent are satin sisters Gauri & Nainika, whose A Closet full of Dresses draws inspiration from the pure abstraction of Russian artist

Wassily Kandinsky. With swathes of colour cutting across clever and simple dresses, the sisters have chosen to "concentrate on colour, cut and form", says Nainika.

And while runways will be captivated by paroxysms of art and electric colour, the list of designers in the Fashion Design Council of India's (FDCI) roster this season is not too impressive. For many, this may not necessarily be the best time of the year for business, since

WHITE IS RIGHT

The effervescence of white sets the tone for the season ahead. Stark whites make a bright statement in Rohit Gandhi and Rahul Khanna's line.

ART ATTACK

From psychedelic artists to Wassily Kandinsky, fashion finds inspiration in art. Ravage, Namrata Joshipura and Fightercock get artistic.

"High colour meets high style", says Gill as she unveils a colourful collection. No points for guessing where she went for her happy holiday. And while somnambulant summer vacations might be inspiring couturiers, some are all set to showcase their artistic affinities. Namrata Joshipura presents a "lavish theatrical production that draws inspiration from the works of the late Cuban American artist Dan

the "big money" is missing from spring-summer saleability. "Autumn-winter lines and trousseau collections rake in the moolah. Spring-summer doesn't cut the cake yet," says a young designer.

Others are off to conquer the runways of the world. As a result, a lot of the big guns are giving catwalk shows a miss. While Anamika Khanna and Manish Arora are off to Paris Fashion Week, Ashish Soni is taking his sporty line to the Big Apple. Rohit Gandhi and Rahul Khanna, too, will be missing in action. "Our autumn-winter line was very well received and we are still delivering on our orders," says Gandhi, whose label Cue is ready with a spring-summer line which will be shown at a stall. And while JJ Valaya just unveiled an opulent bridal couture line in Delhi last week, he is also giving spring-summer a miss due to "certain existing commitments and other new global



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